

Do you need an agent at all?

	answer	model calls	tool calls	
(a) plain python	\$6.25	0	0	PASS
(b) one structured call	\$6.25	1	0	PASS
(c) full agent	\$6.25	3	2	PASS

Same answer, three costs: 0, 1, 3 calls. On a fixed task, autonomy is pure overhead.